



Nima Thing

Computational social science researcher focused on political communication, disinformation, and digital-trace data.

✉ nimathing1995@gmail.com 📍 Berlin, Germany 🌐 [nimathing2052](https://github.com/nimathing2052) 🔗 [nima-thing](https://www.linkedin.com/in/nima-thing)

Education

- | | |
|--|----------------------|
| Hertie School , Data Science for Public Policy | Berlin, Germany |
| • Main fields: Data Science, Governance, Advanced Quantitative Methods. | Aug 2023 – June 2025 |
| • Core subjects: Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Natural Language Processing, Causal Inference. | |
| • Data for Good Full Scholarship , Dieter Schwarz Stiftung. | |
| The Open Institute for Social Science , Research and Writing in Social Science | Lalitpur, Nepal |
| • Research design, critical epistemology and methodology, ethnographic theory. | Aug 2021 – June 2022 |
| Tribhuvan University , Electronics and Communication Engineering | Kathmandu, Nepal |
| | 2014 – 2018 |

Experience

- | | |
|---|----------------------------|
| University of Bern , Subcontractor, Generative AI Hate-Speech Risk Study | Bern, Switzerland / Remote |
| Short-term subcontracted research role supporting a multi-method study on risks of hate-speech propagation by generative AI. | Aug 2026 – Aug 2026 |
| • Built and benchmarked a 5-model LLM classification pipeline for a hate-speech study, improving macro F1 from ~0.68 to ~0.86 and scaling analysis to 8,523 outputs. | 1 month |
| logiq.media , Computational Social Science Researcher & Lead Developer (part-time) | Berlin / Remote |
| Volunteer researcher (Jan–Mar 2026); part-time from Apr 2026. | Jan 2026 – present |
| • On SHIFT (Shaping Informed Frameworks for Trust), a 13-country European Narratives Observatory project. Builds audience segmentation and narrative-mapping pipelines to identify bridging actors and high-risk narrative clusters for counter-narrative experiments. | 8 months |
| • Lead developer of ElfBot , a prototype for AI-based Facebook comment moderation (ingestion/polling/webhooks backend; classifier rules and fine-tuned LLMs) detecting trolls and toxic comments with human-in-the-loop review; v1 focused on disinformation triage, surfacing coordinated-behavior signals for analyst review (intro-video). | |
| • Co-authored empirical commentary on the gap between fact-checking output volume and public reception in contested feeds — submitted to the HKS Misinformation Review . | |
| Weizenbaum Institute & University of Bern , Short-term Computer Engineer | Berlin, Germany |
| Research infrastructure for longitudinal platform auditing. | Dec 2025 – Dec 2025 |
| • Designed reproducible, modular web-scraping framework (Botasaurus) for algorithmic auditing of Yandex and Google in Kremlin-disinformation research — GitHub . | 1 month |
| • Implemented fingerprint evasion, proxy orchestration, CAPTCHA handling, and structured logging; documented for social-science researchers. | |

Welthungerhilfe — Digital Services & Operations , Werkstudent (Data Engineering) Bridging data science with humanitarian research at a leading international NGO. - Developed and maintained automated data pipelines (Python, PySpark, Microsoft Fabric, Azure Data Factory) integrating employee and training data from external APIs — eliminating manual processes and improving data accuracy. - Built robust API integrations (token management, pagination, rate limiting, error handling); improved pipeline logging and monitoring with real-time progress tracking; performed technical error analysis and optimization of pipelines. - Led proof-of-concept for automated metadata ingestion and data lineage (OpenMetadata, PyApacheAtlas, MS Purview); presented governance framework at internal workshop with Viadee served as technical point of contact for teams and stakeholders.	Bonn, Germany Apr 2024 – July 2025 1 year 4 months
Immobilien Scout GmbH , Quality Specialist (Mobile) Executed 20+ integration and A/B tests on Android/iOS; implemented Maestro automation framework improving efficiency by ~30%.	Berlin, Germany Oct 2023 – Apr 2024 7 months
Qniverse Pvt. Ltd. , Lead Automation Engineer - Led QA automation and team mentorship for international research projects; achieved 90% API test coverage ahead of schedule. - Built browser automation and web scraping infrastructure (Selenium, Playwright) used across multiple UKRI-funded projects. - Employment Guru Award (2023) for QA leadership and process optimization.	Kathmandu, Nepal Aug 2022 – Sept 2023 1 year 2 months
Verisk Nepal Pvt. Ltd. , Software Engineer, Data Analytics - Developed performance-testing and schema-comparison tools (.NET Core/C#) for REST APIs; reduced deployment cycles from hours to minutes. - Built Python regression test suites for AWS/Snowflake data-ingestion ETL pipeline.	Lalitpur, Nepal Feb 2019 – Aug 2022 3 years 7 months

Volunteer

DeepTrace — South Asia Deepfake Detection , Research Assistant (Volunteer) Dataset annotation and benchmark development for underrepresented contexts. - Established annotation guidelines and benchmarks for AI-generated visual content in South Asian contexts. - Contributed dataset-collection UI/UX design — deepfake-research.org.	Remote Nov 2025 – Jan 2026
Koç University (EnlightenAI / Human-AI Interaction) , Summer Research Intern Social media data tooling and NLP feature engineering. - Built TikTok web-scraping and metadata tooling; comparative assessment of third-party data providers. - Contributed Named Entity Recognition features for search models with Human-AI Interaction team.	Istanbul, Turkey July 2025 – Sept 2025

Projects

Pre-Mobilization Reorganization of Online Discourse before Nepal's September 2025 Gen-Z Protest (In Progress) Ongoing cross-platform analysis examining network restructuring before mass political protest. Uses Meta Content Library and structured Reddit collection (ArcticShift API). Accepted poster (Reddit Specific) — see How Are You, Democracy? 2026 .	2026 – present
Beyond the Ballot — TikTok Virality and Political Engagement in Nepal's 2022 Elections MSc thesis (Hertie School, submitted and completed 2025; Prof. Simon Munzert). Revised after committee feedback; not yet published as a journal article. Multimodal ML study of 28,165 videos; full model AUC 0.800. Code . Presented at TCSS 2026 and SICSS-Saarbrücken 2025 .	2024 – 2025

Stance Polarization & Community Structure on Bluesky ~156K posts: zero-shot stance classification, toxicity scoring (Perspective API), author-network analysis. Poster at SICSS-Saarbrücken 2025 .	2025 – 2025
--	-------------

Mapping Elite Attention Ecosystems on Instagram (Nepal) Network analysis of influential activists and attention structure around Nepal’s Gen-Z digital movement. Proposal .	2026 – 2026
---	-------------

Presentations

How Are You, Democracy? (Karlsruhe, 2026)
Accepted poster — Beyond the ban: co-engagement network signals on Nepali Reddit in the run-up to the Sep 8 Gen Z protest (25 June 2026). See [Pre-Protest Reorganization project](#).

Youth in a Digital Society (University of Potsdam, 2026)
Accepted poster for my Master Thesis (8 October 2026).

TCSS 2026 (Koç University, Istanbul)
Talk — TikTok virality and political engagement in Nepal’s 2022 election. [Slides](#). See [Beyond the Ballot project](#).

SICSS-Saarbrücken & MPIB (2025)
Posters — TikTok virality and political engagement in Nepal’s 2022 election ([SICSS poster](#), [MPIB poster](#)), and stance polarization on Bluesky. See [Beyond the Ballot](#) and [Stance Polarization on Bluesky](#) projects.

SSaLM, Weizenbaum Institute (2025)
Poster — deploying DistilBERT to detect and mitigate information bias. [Poster](#).

Awards

Data for Good Scholarship Full scholarship for the Hertie School’s Msc. Data Science for Public Policy programme. Dieter Schwarz Stiftung	2023
--	------

Employment Guru Award Recognition for QA automation leadership. Qniverse Pvt. Ltd.	2023
---	------

ESSA Scholarship BEHAVE Summer School on Agent-Based Modelling for Social Scientists. ESSA	2022
---	------

Verisk Way to Go Recognition for API testing and data-analysis tooling. Verisk Analytics	2020
---	------

Skills

Computational Social Science

Machine Learning & NLP

Engineering & Data

Languages

English
Professional / fluent

Nepali

Native

Hindi

Professional

German

A2 (beginner)

Certificates

Digital Governance

2025

Algorithmic Fairness

2025